

6.8.1 Writer

Writer is the word processor of the OpenOffice.org Suite. The first thing that you would notice when you start the word processor is the similarity in the look and feel of Writer to MS Word. It's clear that the developers have based this, and as you'll see, the whole Suite on Microsoft's bestselling Office which actually isn't such a bad thing. It has all the features that you have come to expect from a word processor and more. The wizards provided, which are basically templates and other commonly used tasks, are useful and you also have the ability to create your own templates. Document converter and Euro converter are nice touches too. Other features include the ability to publish your work directly into the PDF format or export it to the web in HTML. You can also create tables and other objects. The list doesn't end here and there are truckloads of features which you'll discover as you use the Writer more. Compatibility issues are not issues anymore thanks to Writer's ability to open and save documents in Word's format. You also have the ability to save your work in the OpenDocument Format which means that your document can be opened by any program that supports the OpenDocument format.

6.8.2 Calc

Calc is the spreadsheet program of the suite. Again if you've used Excel you'll feel right at home using Calc and you'll also probably end up sticking to it. As expected the standard feature set is all there without exception. The extra features though are the ones to check out. The DataPilot function allows you to summarize and rearrange large amounts of data into meaningful tables. The ability to use natural language formulas makes understanding various functions easy. Scenario is another very interesting tool. These basically are aids which help you show various calculations on numbers that are dependent on each other. Templates are present here too and end up being quite useful due to their inbuilt functions. You also have the option of saving your work in the OpenDocument format and also in the PDF format. You can again open and save your documents in Excel format.